NCCP 00253 · VERSION 6

Tamoxifen · daily hormone therapy

Take tamoxifen once daily continuously. There is no planned week off. The prescriber confirms the duration for the treatment setting.

> Discussion aid: review with the patient and complete the approved local consent process.

Purpose and plan

☐ Exact indication, treatment aim and uncertainty explained

☐ Expected duration and review / switch points discussed

☐ Alternatives and the option not to proceed discussed

☐ Patient priorities, capacity and support needs explored

Practical safety

☐ Medicine, route, schedule and missed-dose instructions

☐ Menopause and ovarian-suppression requirements if relevant

☐ Pregnancy, contraception / fertility and breastfeeding

☐ Monitoring, symptom reporting and contact plan

Tamoxifen: material risks

☐ Hot flushes, sweating and sleep disturbance

☐ Blood clots in the leg or lung; stroke

☐ Visual disturbance / cataracts

☐ QT rhythm risk in susceptible patients

☐ Rare blood-count changes, high calcium and worsening of hereditary angioedema

☐ Vaginal / sexual symptoms and menstrual changes

☐ Endometrial changes and cancer risk

☐ Liver effects and uncommon serious skin reactions

☐ Reduced bone density can occur before menopause; the effect on bone differs after menopause

Discuss the expected benefit in your treatment setting alongside clot, womb, eye and liver risks and effects on daily life. Tell the team about previous clots, severe liver disease and all other medicines. Tamoxifen is not contraception: discuss an effective non-hormonal method during treatment and for nine months after stopping, where relevant. Absent periods do not prove infertility. Pregnancy and breastfeeding are excluded from this NCCP pathway. Do not change antidepressants, blood thinners or other regular medicines yourself.

Individual benefit, alternatives and concerns

Agreed checks and next review

Before treatment, check blood count, kidney and liver function, clot history, medicines and pregnancy possibility. The current Irish Tamox product information also recommends an eye examination before treatment and regular blood-count, liver and calcium checks; the team agrees their timing for your product. ECG and electrolyte checks depend on heart-rhythm risks or symptoms. NCCP recommends an annual gynaecological examination. Report unusual vaginal bleeding or visual changes promptly.

Clinician / date: _____ Patient discussion documented: _____

Consent is an ongoing conversation and may be reconsidered. This aid is not treatment authorisation.

SACTCheck · Developed by Dr Paul O'Brien · v0.84.20 · Sources checked 2026-10-25
Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending